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To Whom It May Concern

It is my pleasure to recommend **Mr. Mohak Ketan Patil**, a 2024 graduate of the Integrated Master's Programme in Physics at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Roorkee, for a birding and biodiversity-related position at Adani, Mundra. I have known Mohak closely through his involvement with the Community for Campus Fauna (CCF), where I served as the Head, and have consistently been impressed by his knowledge, dedication, and leadership in the field of ornithology and wildlife conservation.

Mohak is one of the founding members of the IIT Roorkee Bird-watching Community and has played a pivotal role in promoting birding, biodiversity awareness, and wildlife conservation at IIT Roorkee and in the surrounding areas. As the leader of the student group *Feathers of Roorkee*, he has organized and led numerous bird walks, awareness programmes, and conservation activities, inspiring students and the local community to appreciate and protect avian diversity. He has also guided visiting faculty, researchers, and participants attending academic conferences and the Nurturing Future Leadership Programme (NFLP), while mentoring students in bird identification and ethical field observation techniques.

Mohak possesses exceptional field birding skills and has developed an excellent understanding of bird taxonomy, ecology, behaviour, and habitat associations. He is highly proficient in identifying birds using plumage, morphology, flight patterns, silhouettes, behaviour, and other field characteristics. His auditory identification skills are particularly noteworthy, as he can accurately recognize more than 75 bird species solely by their vocalizations. His patience, keen observation, and ability to detect subtle movements and sounds in the field make him an outstanding birder. He has documented nearly 180 bird species on eBird and continues to enhance his expertise through regular field surveys and birding expeditions.

To further strengthen his knowledge, Mohak successfully completed the NPTEL SWAYAM Basic Course in Ornithology offered by IIT Madras. He has also undertaken field visits to renowned birding and conservation sites, including Jim Corbett National Park, Keoladeo National Park, the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), and other important birding locations, where he gained valuable practical experience from experienced ornithologists and field experts.

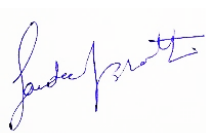
Mohak has made several significant contributions to bird documentation and conservation at IIT Roorkee. He co-developed the IITR Bird Calendar 2025 and contributed to compiling a comprehensive, ground-verified checklist of approximately 180 bird species recorded in and around the campus. His expertise was frequently sought by faculty members, researchers, and visiting groups for bird surveys and field visits. Beyond documentation, he actively participated

in awareness campaigns and citizen science initiatives, including the Uttarakhand Bird Count through the eBird Uttarakhand community.

What distinguishes Mohak is his strong commitment to ethical birding and conservation. He consistently follows responsible field practices that prioritize the welfare of wildlife and their habitats. His dedication is reflected in his efforts to monitor the endangered Egyptian Vultures nesting on the IIT Roorkee campus and in his careful rescue and successful return of a fallen vulture chick to its nest.

Mohak combines scientific curiosity, exceptional field skills, leadership, and a deep passion for biodiversity conservation. I am confident that he will be an invaluable asset to any organization involved in bird conservation, ecological monitoring, environmental management, or biodiversity assessment. I recommend him wholeheartedly and without reservation, and I am certain he will make meaningful contributions to your organization.

Sincerely,



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